

Bazaar

QUICK
INSIGHTS
FROM INDEPTH
TESTS

The Digit Test Centre receives hundreds of products every month. Each of these products is put through a series of tests, and is finally given a verdict. The final score is arrived at after considering a number of factors and evaluating them in terms of features, performance, value for money, build quality, and, in the case of software, even ease of use.

For better understanding of our ratings, here's a quick guide to our overall score

- 1.0 - 3.0 - Extremely poor product. Keep away!
- 3.5 - 5.0 - Strictly OK. Not recommended
- 5.5 - 6.5 - Decent product. Go for it, but there may be better products out there.
- 7.0 - 8.5 - Very good product. Highly recommended.
- 9.0-10.0 - Ground-breaking product. We've never seen anything like it before. A definite must buy!



PirateBay to allow physical downloads

A new file category called Physibles lets you print mock models of objects on real 3D printers, its an expensive exercise though
<http://bit.ly/wPEw1R>

HARD DRIVE



WD 1 TB Scorpio Blue (WD10JPVT)
Price: ₹10,650

MONITOR



ASUS ML238H
Price: ₹10,600

SPECIFICATIONS

Capacity.....1 TB
InterfaceSATA 2
Cache buffer8 MB
Rotational Speed.....5400RPM

Screen size23-inch
Type.....LED backlit LCD
Display PortsD-Sub, HDMI
Response time (gray to gray) 2ms

TEST CENTRE RATINGS (All Scores out of 10)

Features.....7.0

It has two 500 GB platters which it manages to fit in the 9.5mm thick drive. This is an advanced 4K format drive.

Performance.....6.5

HD Tune Pro Read Burst speed: 195.3 MB/s. Real world Read / Write (Sequential)(MB/s): 109 / 106 and Read / Write (Assorted)(MB/s): 77 / 69.

Build quality8.0

Just like its older siblings, the build quality on this drive is top class.

Value for money4.0

At ₹10,650 it's quite heavily priced, but then that's the case with all HDDs today after the Thailand floods.

Features.....7.0

It has a variety of options and colour profiles to choose from the OSD. Comes with a unique stand.

Performance7.0

Contrast ratio acc to Spyder3Elite at 50 percent levels was around 478:1 which is decent. Skin tones rendered well.

Build Quality.....6.5

Glossy finish is a fingerprint magnet. Touchscreen menu buttons are a pain to operate. Stand is not very stable.

Value for Money.....7.0

At ₹10,600 for the unique design and performance, its a good price point.

WE SAY

6.0

The WD Scorpio Blue 1TB is a good drive for those looking at mere capacities and are not really concerned with the performance. The sequential speeds which are comfortably over 100 MB/s are good enough for everyday usage. For performance enthusiasts, the older WD Scorpion Black 750GB (WD7500BPKT) is still the drive to opt for. The pricing of ₹10,650 gives a cost per GB of ₹10.74 which is very high. Due to the floods in Thailand, which has the manufacturing hubs of these drives, prices have gone up. We would advise you to wait till the HDD prices reach sensible levels.

7.0

ASUS ML238 is a great full HD monitor with good looks for its price. We liked the various modes such as sRGB, Adobe RGB, Theatre, etc. The colours were rendered well and we found the sRGB mode to be the best amongst others. HD movie viewing experience was quite good but we noticed slight backlight bleeding in pitch dark scenes. Readability of text was quite good but we were put off with just a VGA and HDMI display out. It does come with DVI to HDMI converter and a range of power connector cords. Banding wasn't an issue. Assembling the stand is a bit of a task though.